

Node.js - Wikipedia

Overview

This page provides an overview of Node.js, a cross-platform, open-source JavaScript runtime environment. Node.js allows developers to run JavaScript on the server-side, enabling the creation of scalable and high-performance web applications. The page covers the history, features, and ecosystem of Node.js.

Key Points

- Node.js is a JavaScript runtime environment that can run on multiple platforms, including Windows, Linux, and macOS.
- It was initially written by Ryan Dahl in 2009 and is now maintained by the OpenJS Foundation.
- Node.js uses the V8 JavaScript engine and provides an event-driven, non-blocking I/O model.
- It has a large ecosystem of packages and modules, with over 1 million packages available on the npm registry.
- Node.js is widely used in web development, with popular frameworks such as Express.js and Next.js.
- It also supports WebAssembly and has experimental support for WASI, the WebAssembly System Interface.
- Node.js has a strong community, with numerous conferences, meetups, and online forums.

In Depth

Node.js was created to address the limitations of traditional web development, where server-side programming was typically done in languages like PHP or Ruby. By allowing developers to use JavaScript on the server-side, Node.js enables a "JavaScript everywhere" paradigm, where developers can use a single language for both client-side and server-side development. This approach has led to the creation of numerous frameworks and libraries that simplify web development, such as Express.js and React.

One of the key features of Node.js is its event-driven, non-blocking I/O model, which allows it to handle a large number of concurrent connections with minimal overhead. This makes Node.js well-suited for real-time web applications, such as chat apps and live updates. Additionally, Node.js has a large ecosystem of packages and modules, which can be easily installed and managed using the npm package manager.

Node.js also has a strong focus on community and governance, with the OpenJS Foundation providing a framework for collaborative development and decision-making. This has led to the creation of numerous working groups and committees, which focus on specific areas such as security, documentation, and testing. Overall, Node.js has become a popular choice for web development, with its unique approach to server-side programming and its large, active community.

Takeaway

The most important thing to remember about Node.js is that it enables developers to run JavaScript on the server-side, allowing for a "JavaScript everywhere" paradigm that simplifies web development and enables the creation of scalable, high-performance web applications.

Source

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